



CHAPTER xviii.

An Act to amend the powers of the Great Eastern Railway Company with respect to the use of steam vessels. A.D. 1904.

[24th June 1904.]

WHEREAS by the Great Eastern Railway (Steamboats) Act 1863 (hereinafter called "the Act of 1863") the Great Eastern Railway Company (hereinafter called "the Company") were authorised to establish communication by means of steam vessels between Harwich and Flushing Rotterdam and Antwerp and to exercise various powers in reference to steam vessels:

And whereas the Company established such communication between (amongst other places) Harwich and Rotterdam:

And whereas in consequence of the establishment of railway communication between the Hook of Holland and Rotterdam and the provision of facilities for embarkation and disembarkation at the Hook of Holland the vessels of the Company plying between Harwich and Rotterdam have since the year 1893 called at that place:

And whereas the passenger traffic to and from Rotterdam and places beyond viâ the Hook of Holland has of late years greatly increased while that by sea direct to and from Rotterdam has diminished:

And whereas it is expedient that the Company be authorised to run steam vessels between Harwich and the Hook of Holland without proceeding to or starting from Rotterdam:

And whereas it is expedient that the maximum charges which by the Act of 1863 the Company are empowered to make in respect of the conveyance of passengers in their steam vessels between Harwich and Flushing Rotterdam and Antwerp be increased as hereinafter provided:

[Price 3d.]

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And whereas by the Great Eastern Railway (Steamboats) Act 1867 (hereinafter called “the Act of 1867”) powers were conferred upon the Company of running steam vessels between Harwich and the ports of Harlingen and Geestemünde and it is expedient that such powers be further extended as hereinafter provided :

And whereas it is expedient that the Company be authorised to enter into agreements with respect to the provision of facilities for their steam vessels and the traffic conveyed thereby :

And whereas the objects of this Act cannot be effected without the authority of Parliament :

May it therefore please Your Majesty that it may be enacted and be it enacted by the King’s most Excellent Majesty by and with the advice and consent of the Lords Spiritual and Temporal and Commons in this present Parliament assembled and by the authority of the same as follows (that is to say) :—

Short title.

1. This Act may be cited for all purposes as the Great Eastern Railway (Steamboats) Act 1904.

Power to run steam vessels.

2. The Act of 1863 shall be read and have effect as if the Hook of Holland had been mentioned in Section 1 thereof as well as the towns or ports of Flushing Rotterdam and Antwerp.

Rates for steam vessels to Flushing &c.

3. Section 2 of the Act of 1863 is hereby repealed and from and after the passing of this Act the charges to be made by the Company for the conveyance of passengers in steam vessels under the powers of that Act as amended by this Act between the points of embarkation and disembarkation shall not in respect of passengers conveyed between Harwich on the one hand and Flushing Rotterdam Antwerp and the Hook of Holland on the other hand and vice versâ exceed the following charges (that is to say) :—

Rotterdam Antwerp and Hook of Holland.						Flushing.			
First Class	-	-	-	-	20s.	First Class	-	-	17s.
Second Class	-	-	-	-	15s.	Second Class	-	-	13s.
Third Class	-	-	-	-	10s.	Third Class	-	-	9s.

Power to run steam vessels to Zeebrugge.

4. Section 2 of the Act of 1867 shall be read and have effect as if the port or town of Zeebrugge had been mentioned therein as well as the ports of Harlingen and Geestemünde.

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5. The Company may from time to time enter into and carry into effect agreements for and in relation to the construction or appropriation for the use of the Company's steam vessels and of the traffic conveyed or to be conveyed thereby of quays wharves offices warehouses depôts slaughter-houses or other accommodation at any of the ports or places to which their steam vessels from time to time run upon and subject to such terms and conditions as the Company think fit.

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Agreements.

6. The Company may raise and apply for or towards any of the purposes of this Act or of any agreement made thereunder being purposes to which capital is properly applicable any money which they are authorised to raise by any other Act or Acts and which may not be required for the special purposes (if any) for which that money was authorised to be raised.

Application
of funds.

7. Nothing in this Act contained shall exempt the Company or their railways from the provisions of any general Act relating to railways or the better or more impartial audit of the accounts of railway companies passed before or after the passing of this Act or from any future revision or alteration under the authority of Parliament of the maximum rates of fares and charges or of the rates for small parcels authorised to be taken by the Company.

Provision as
to general
Railway
Acts.

8. All costs charges and expenses of and incidental to the preparing for obtaining and passing of this Act or otherwise in relation thereto shall be paid by the Company.

Costs of Act.

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